Design dash and group formation reflection report

The group creation process went very smoothly. During the break after the initial lecture, I quickly started talking with some fellow students. When finding three others that had complimentary group roles, the decision to work together for this project was easily made. Although we do have our different roles assigned, actually putting this into practice seemed a bit less straightforward. But throughout the workshop (and later, when discussing practical matters), with some effort from each of the members, I can feel that the different roles are emerging.
When starting the workshop, I, and some of my fellow students were a bit sceptical as to what the use could be. Seeing the simple arts and crafts tools in the room upon entering felt a bit out of place in the engineering course. The initial phase, when we had to come up with our needs and associations for our topic (lunch), was hesitant. We did not really understand what the use for this was. I found it difficult to come up with my needs or associations with said topic, as eating lunch seems straightforward, and something I never really spend much time thinking about. But after going through the different steps of the workshop, I could feel the group as a whole become more excited while discussing possible limitations and inefficiencies in the standard ways lunch serving systems (like the UGent resto) are built. I was the person that was interviewed for my needs by another group. Although this was an entirely different topic to ours (reading the news), the way they approached the matter gave me inspiration to attack our topic from a different angle. When returning to my group, I saw that they had also gained valuable new insights and inspiration by interviewing someone else. Finally, when we started to design our solution, I was surprised that the idea we had come up with in only 30 minutes did not seem that stupid. On the contrary. After re-iterating with the interviewee, we arrived at a concept that could in my opinion (partly) solve the long queues we have at the UGent resto when people are waiting to be served for a warm lunch.